of a memorandum, was written by Sir Olaf Caroe, the then Secretary of External Affairs, on 19 September 1945, in reply to certain queries raised by the new British Foreign Secretary, Ernest Bevin.[7] The second memorandum[8] was written in 1946 when the British General Staff prepared a top-secret memo entitled, 'Appreciation of the scale of direct military assistance which could be provided in support of Tibet'.

Geopolitically, as mentioned in the Department of External Affairs' memorandum of 25 October 1947, India was just about to suffer a major defeat, just like the defeat of the British in Afghanistan, in 1841–42. The Gilgit Agency, which was the key to the defence of the western end of the northern frontier, the crucial zone where Afghanistan, Russia and China meet, was almost slipping away from the control of Jammu and Kashmir. It seemed like it would formally be placed under the flag of Pakistan, in less than a week's time. Consequently, India's north-west frontier had been pushed several hundred miles to the east and a century of British strategic planning (which included the sale of Kashmir to Gulab Singh in 1846) had been undone. The real goal of the military intervention which began on 27 October 1947 was to gain control over not the valley of Kashmir but the Gilgit Agency. The memorandum of 25 October 1947 makes it clear that the state of Jammu and Kashmir was of fundamental importance to India and that had nothing to do with the fact that it was Nehru's ancestral home. The legal merits of the Maharaja's Instrument of Accession were also not the main reason for the state's significance for India. It was the symbol of India's status as the true successor to the British Raj.

The announcement of this memorandum, possibly inspired by Sardar Patel, was in congruence with the interests of the British deep state. However, unless Patel was made the Prime Minister of India, the British deep state could not be sure that India could be relied upon to deliver on Britain's strategic interests. That was the paradox which caused the anxiety for the British to immediately execute Operation Datta Khel, in order to thwart the realisation of Patel's strategic vision for the defence of the Dominion of India.